

email accounts quite a bit differently than it does multiple contact or calendar accounts. You'll see why this is so, and how you can work around this odd limitation, as we explore Windows Phone's Mail application in this chapter.

Push Mail

Mobile communications has existed for almost as long as there have been mobile devices, though of course the advent of pervasive wireless network connectivity finally made this scenario both interesting and viable and, eventually, indispensable. Early PDAs offered simple communication solutions, including mobile email, but they required PC connectivity or, in rare cases, a mobile modem in order to send and receive messages over the air.

The first big breakthrough in mobile email came courtesy of Research In Motion (RIM), which started not with PDAs but rather with pagers, tiny mobile devices that utilized communications net-

works to send simple messages to customers. These pagers gradually morphed into the BlackBerry line of smart phones, which adopted email, web browsing, text messaging, contacts management, and other functionality, just as PDAs also morphed into smart phones by adding telephony capabilities. RIM's early experience in the wireless world gave it an interesting advantage in certain areas, and the company was the first to offer what's now called "push" support for email, as well as contacts and calendars. Previous to push, mobile devices would occasionally poll servers wirelessly for new data and then sync whatever changes had occurred. But push technologies perform the same feat in a far more efficient manner:

Instead of requiring clients to blindly ask for changes on a schedule, push-based services simply "push" changes down to the clients, and they do so only whenever a change occurs. The result is that devices get better overall battery life since they're not constantly sending out wireless feelers.



Windows Live is just one of the many accounts you can check on your WP7